

What does ‘small numbers’ mean?

The 2026 hunting quotas, checked against Malta’s own legal benchmark

THE CLAIM

“Under strictly supervised conditions ... in small numbers”

Directive 2009/147/EC, Article 9(1)(c)

Malta’s 2026 quotas: 2,400 Quail · 1,500 Turtle-doves

The benchmark is a statutory model, not a count of birds migrating over Malta.

VERDICT

NOT SUBSTANTIATED

*The quota maths fits;
implementation is open.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

99.3%

Quail quota / benchmark

2,400 quota against the regulation's
2,416-bird 1% benchmark.

59.8%

Turtle-dove quota / benchmark

1,500 quota against the regulation's
2,510-bird 1% benchmark.

Declining

Turtle-dove context

WBRU reports a continuing
central-eastern flyway decline; latest
Article 12 data were provisional.

2025

Latest outcome report

WBRU records 1,336 patrols, 909
spot-checks and 19 detected offences
for 2025.

Not yet

2026 supervision

No 2026 season outcome report was
listed in the WBRU archive at the 3
October review cut-off.

FAIR TO SAY

Both quotas are below the legal
mortality benchmark. That confirms
the formula was followed on the
Government's inputs; it does not
prove sustainability or strict
supervision in practice.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ Publish the 2026 outcome and enforcement data.

☐ Show the final population inputs and mortality method.

☐ Publish the Ornis minutes and vote.

☐ Release and independently validate the FKNK survey
results.